

4.0 CARING FOR BABAY SKIN

Newborn babies have very sensitive skin. Here's how to take care of it.

4.1.1 BEFORE THE UMBILICAL CORD FALLS OFF GIVE SPONGE BATHS

The baby's umbilical cord will fall off 1 to 3 weeks after birth. Until then, you should only give sponge baths. Use a soft cloth and warm water, but no soap.

4.1.2 AFTER THE UMBILICAL CORD FALLS OFF GIVE TUB BATHS

Once the cord falls off, you can use a special baby bathtub. It's OK to use a small amount of baby shampoo, but it's not needed. Unless your baby gets very dirty, 2 or 3 baths a week should be enough. More baths may dry out her skin. Just be sure to clean her diaper area well during changes. Keep bath time safe. To keep the baby safe in the bath, follow these safety tips.

4.1.3 SHIELD YOUR BABY'S SKIN FROM THE SUN

The sun's rays can harm your baby's skin. No amount of direct sunlight is safe for infants. Even if the baby has darker skin, the sun can cause damage. So keep the baby in the shade as much as you can for the first 6 months of life. If she must go out in the sun, cover her with a hat and clothing. It's OK to use sunscreen on small areas of her body, such as on her face and the backs of her hands.

4.1.4 CHOOSE SKIN PRODUCTS WISELY

In most cases, the baby does not need any lotions, oils, or powders. If her skin is dry, put a small amount of unscented lotion, cream, or ointment on those areas. If she has a diaper rash, use special diaper rash ointment.

4.1.5 TAKE CARE OF YOUR BABY BOY'S PENIS

For the first few months, clean the baby's penis with mild, unscented soap and warm water. Cotton swabs and germ killers are not needed. If your baby boy was circumcised The tip of his penis may look raw or yellowish. His penis should be fully healed about 1 week to 10 days after circumcision. If there is a bandage, replace it at each diaper change to lower the risk of germs. Use petroleum jelly to keep the bandage from sticking. Sometimes a plastic ring is used instead of a bandage. The ring should fall off within 5 to 8 days. If the baby boy was not circumcised Do not pull back the foreskin when you clean his penis. Wait until he's older.